

The Cast



THE VICTIM

Nicholas "Nick" Frost, founder of the Frost & Fable Toy Company. Generous in public, ruthless in business. Loved anything peppermint.

Core characters (always played)



Robin Holly
HEAD TOYMAKER

Fifteen years of toys, and one very quiet smile. Frost & Fable's head toymaker for fifteen years and the creator of the Jingle Bear, the company's best-selling toy. Known for loving Christmas, plants and the old ways of making things.
Costume: Green apron, reading glasses, a pencil behind the ear. **Go all out:** a vintage workshop look: waistcoat, rolled sleeves, round spectacles, a green work apron and a wooden toy in hand.



Jordan Tinsel
FINANCE DIRECTOR

The numbers always add up. Almost always. Nick's business partner for ten years and the company's numbers person. You carried Nick's red mug to him at the 9 o'clock toast.
Costume: Sharp suit, tinsel scarf, calculator. **Go all out:** a velvet blazer or three-piece suit, a gold tinsel scarf, a pocket watch and a ledger under one arm.



Sam Garland
NICK'S NEPHEW OR NIECE

Every mystery writer needs a plot. Tonight, you are in one. Nick's only family, and so his heir. A mystery writer who hasn't been published yet. Arrived on the evening train.
Costume: Cozy cardigan, notebook, scarf. **Go all out:** literary chic: a chunky cable-knit cardigan, a tartan scarf, a fountain pen and a battered notebook.



Casey Sleigh
CATERER

The eggnog was perfect. Wasn't it? Owner of Sleigh Bells Catering. You made tonight's food and the big bowl of eggnog, and you filled Nick's red mug just before the toast.
Costume: White apron, chef's hat, ladle. **Go all out:** a crisp white chef's jacket, a tall toque, a candy-stripe apron and a silver ladle.



The Cast, continued



Alex Snow
RIVAL TOYMAKER

Uninvited, unbothered, and colder than the snow outside. Owner of Snow Toys, Frost & Fable's biggest rival. Nobody invited you. You arrived by taxi at 7:15.

Costume: All white, frosty silver accessories. **Go all out:** ice royalty: head-to-toe white and silver, a faux-fur stole and sparkly snowflake jewellery.



Morgan Ivy
PERSONAL ASSISTANT

You hold the keys, the list and half the secrets in the lodge. Nick's personal assistant for six years. You planned tonight's party, ran the Secret Santa draw and hold most of the lodge keys.

Costume: Smart outfit, clipboard, a ring of keys. **Go all out:** office polish: a tailored blazer, a silk scarf or tie, statement glasses, a clipboard and a jangling ring of keys.

Optional characters (add in this order)



Taylor Star
HIRED SANTA

Ho, ho... who? An actor hired to play Santa tonight. You've been by the tree all evening, handing out presents.

Costume: Santa suit, or an elf costume. **Go all out:** the full Santa suit with a fluffy beard, or a velvet elf costume with striped stockings and a bell.



Charlie Bell
MARKETING MANAGER

Every moment captured. Every photo tells a story. Frost & Fable's marketing manager. You've been taking photos all night for the company newsletter.

Costume: Bright festive jumper, camera or phone. **Go all out:** the loudest Christmas jumper you own (light-up if possible), a vintage camera round your neck and tinsel in your hair.



Frankie Fir
LODGE GARDENER

You know which flowers are pretty, and which are deadly. You look after Snowbury Lodge's grounds and greenhouse, and you carry your own greenhouse key.

Costume: Flannel shirt, wellies, garden gloves. **Go all out:** country-estate gardener: a tweed flat cap or beanie, flannel, wellies and a potted poinsettia under one arm.



The Cast, continued



Quinn Mistletoe
JOURNALIST

Off the record? Nothing is ever off the record. You write for *Toy Trade Weekly*, and you came tonight as a guest, "for the eggnog".

Costume: Trench coat, press badge. **Go all out:** a 1940s newshound: belted trench coat, a fedora with a PRESS card in the band, and a notepad.



Jamie Pudding
VILLAGE BAKER

Sweet on the outside, with an old flame on the inside. You run Pudding's Bakery in the village, and you brought a tray of gingerbread tonight. You and Nick were a couple once, years ago.

Costume: Flour-dusted apron, gingerbread brooch. **Go all out:** a flour-dusted vintage apron, a headscarf, a gingerbread brooch and a plate of biscuits to share.



Riley Carol
HIRED PIANIST

You play the carols, and you hear everything. Hired to play carols all evening. The piano sits near the corridor to the workshop, so you've had a view of most of the room.

Costume: Bow tie or velvet, sheet music. **Go all out:** lounge-pianist glamour: a velvet jacket or dress, a bow tie or pearls, and a folder of carol sheet music.



Inspector Noel
THE HOST

Came for the eggnog and carols. Stayed to solve a murder.

Costume: Tweed coat, scarf, a magnifying glass. **Go all out:** a deerstalker or flat cap, a long checked scarf and a pocket notebook.